

Visa.

A founder's case for adding outbound mobility to the Philippine Creative Industries framework.

THE ASSET

₱2.12T

creative economy, 2025 — 7.6% of GDP

7.51M

Filipinos employed — 17.8% of all jobs

30%

U.S. visa denial rate, FY24

THE FRICTION

30% — U.S. tourist-visa denial rate for PH passports, 3rd highest in SEA. **7.12%** Schengen refusal.

Asymmetric reciprocity: U.S., Korean, and Japanese artists enter PH visa-free; ours don't. Touring artists must apply simultaneously — one delay drops a city.

WHAT IS ALREADY SIGNED

RA 11904 (2022, Philippine Creative Industries Development Act) · **DFA Soft Power Roadmap** (Dec 2024, Sec. Manalo) · **PCIDP MC No. 103** (Oct 2025, Exec. Sec. Bersamin — 10-year implementation plan). Commits to “increase global market presence for Filipino content,” **but contains no outbound mobility provision.**

PROPOSED — A MOBILITY PILLAR IN THE PCIDP IRR

- DFA endorsement-letter system.** *for outbound Filipino artists — building on the Office of Cultural Diplomacy that already exists.*
- Bilateral negotiation priority list.** *U.S., Korea, Japan, EU first. Reciprocity asks delivered through PH embassies.*
- Inter-agency coordination protocol.** *DFA + DTI + NCCA + DMW + IPOPHL — one mobility playbook.*

MECHANISM IRR amendment, not new legislation · **TIMELINE** 6 – 12 months · **COST** **zero new appropriation**

THREE OPTIONS — IN ORDER OF AMBITION

- OPTION A. Convene a Senate hearing.** under Committee on Culture & the Arts. Calls DFA + DTI + NCCA to the table. 30 – 60 days. Minimal cost.
- OPTION B. Push the PCIDP IRR amendment.** direct request to DTI/NCCA. We provide draft language. 6 – 12 months. No new appropriation.
- OPTION C. File the Creative Workers Mobility Act.** you as principal author. Codifies the Mobility Pillar in statute. Carries the next decade of creative policy.

*You've already done it for the athletes (PeSPA, Senate Resolution 276). **Filipino artists are asking for the same chapter.***